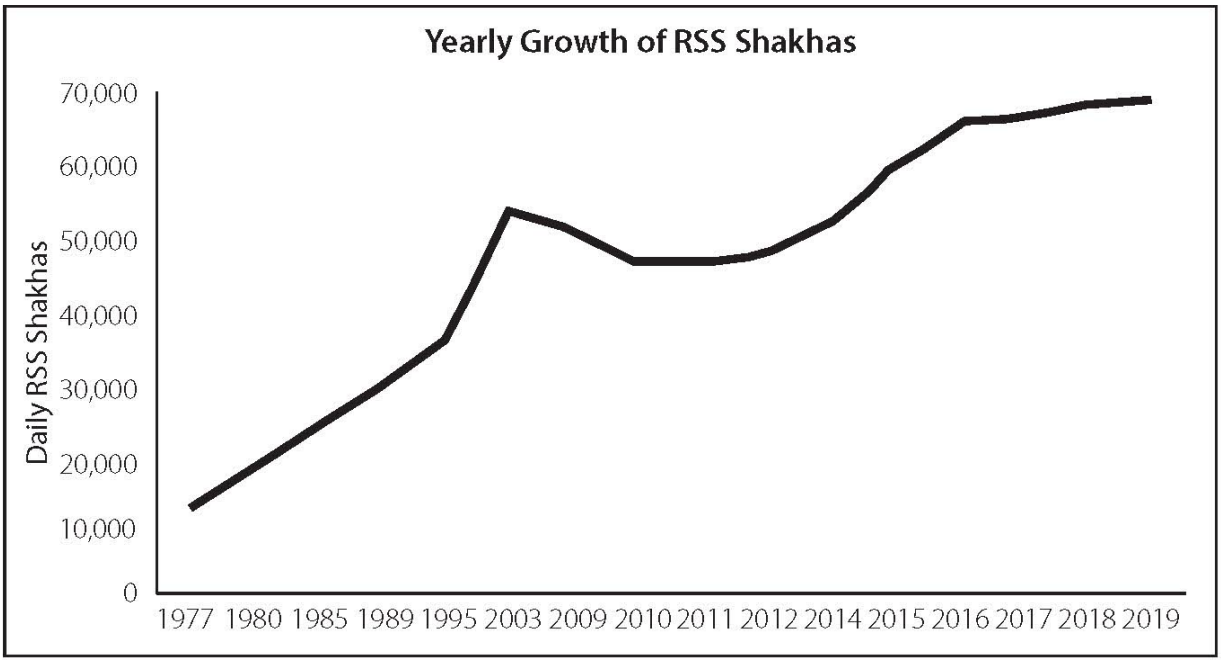
reports. In 2019, the lower range of its membership was 8,88,990 members and the higher range was 59,26,600.[13]

After a decade of decline and stagnation, the inflection point for RSS growth came in 2012, as the anti-corruption movement against the Congress-led UPA government grew in strength. While the RSS supported the India Against Corruption movement, and its cadres formed a large proportion of the mobilisation that drove it,[14] it is unclear whether the Sangh's growth spurt around that time was caused by this involvement or whether it was just a coincidence. Between 2010 and 2014, the daily shakhas went up by 12.9 per cent, weekly Milans by 69.7 per cent and monthly Mandalis by 29.6 per cent. Thereafter, the rate of growth accelerated even further. Between 2014 to 2019, daily shakhas increased by 31.7 per cent and the weekly Milans by 37.9 per cent. However, monthly Mandalis declined by -6.9 per cent (see Figure 12.2).[15] By mid-2019, the RSS's Sahakaryavaha Manmohan Vaidya could claim that the organisation was active in 90 per cent of the blocks in India.[16]

Figure 12.1: RSS Daily Shakhas: Annual Growth (1977–2018)



Source: 2009–2019 data from RSS Annual Reports. 1977–2009 data from Manini Chatterjee, 'Repackaging the RSS', The Indian Express, *16 March 2003*